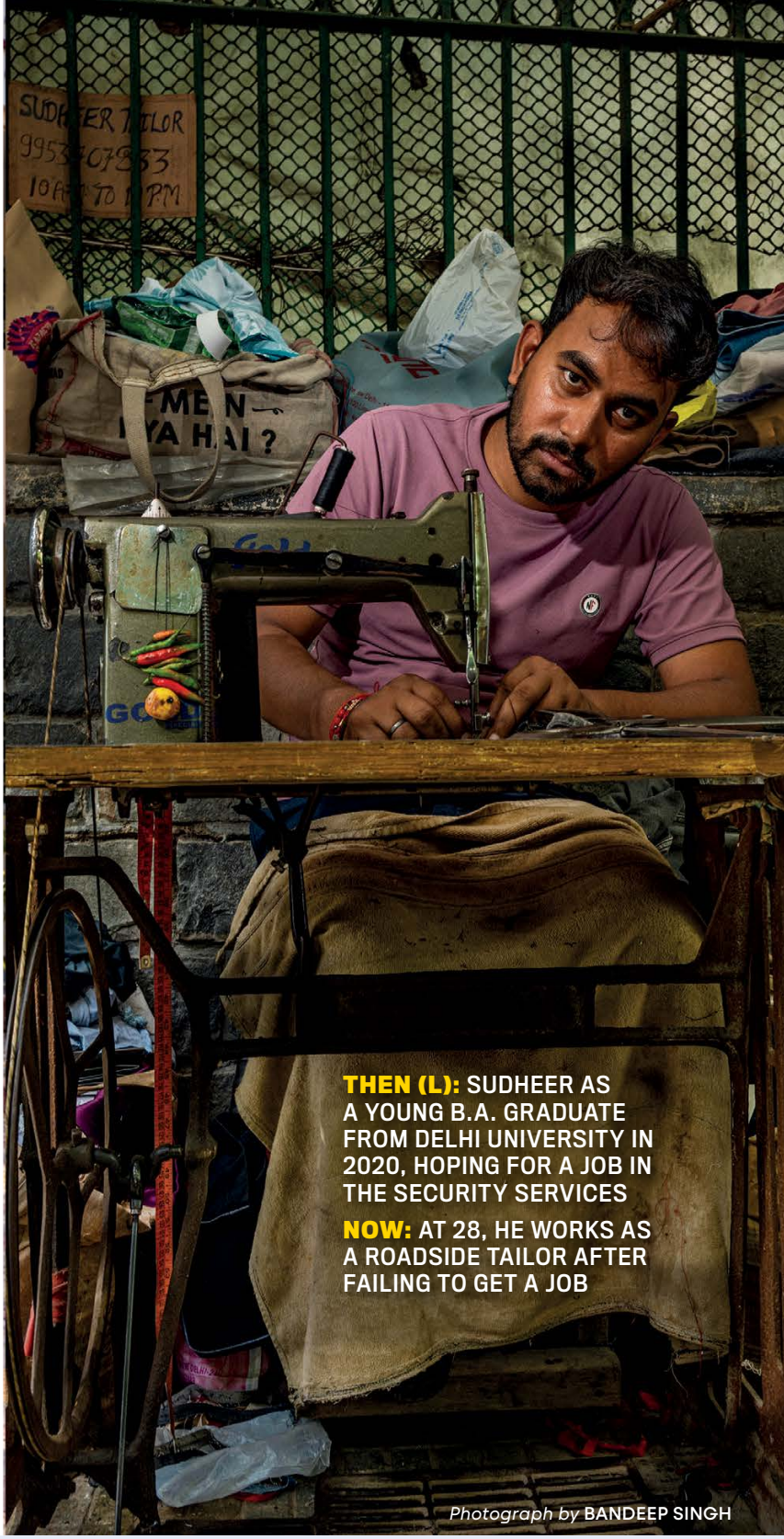


Photo Montage by BANDEEP SINGH/AI



THEN (L): SUDHEER AS A YOUNG B.A. GRADUATE FROM DELHI UNIVERSITY IN 2020, HOPING FOR A JOB IN THE SECURITY SERVICES

NOW: AT 28, HE WORKS AS A ROADSIDE TAILOR AFTER FAILING TO GET A JOB

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

CASE STUDY

Sudheer, 28, Delhi

Tailor

Education: BA from Delhi University

Stitching a Future

A good student all along, with a CGPA of 7.8 in Class 12 and a second division in his BA course in Delhi, Sudheer wanted to write the CISF and Delhi Police exams. But when his tailor father's health began failing, he had to find a job immediately. His quickest option was to learn the basics from local tailors and YouTube and take over his father's business in Defence Colony. A clerk's position in an advocate's office promised Rs 10,000–12,000 a month, but he had to let it go. "I know I could have earned more later, but I didn't have the luxury to earn less even for a month." Today, bent over his sewing machine, Sudheer works from 10 am to 10 pm.

—Sonal Khetarpal